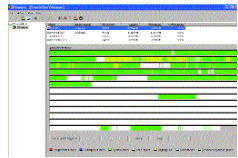


Executive DisKeeper Home Edition v7.0

Destined for defrag

If you are tired of the slow Windows defragmenter, try DisKeeper 7.0. It lets you exclude specific files and folders from the defragmentation process. Its frag-guard feature prevents MFT (Master File Table) and the Windows swap file from fragmenting, hence



improving performance. It also monitors their extent of fragmentation, triggering an automated defragmentation operation during bootup when their level of fragmentation exceeds a preset threshold. This application is extremely light, runs as a background service and consumes around

Price: Rs 1,560
Contact: Crystal Solutions Pvt Ltd
Phone: 022-5953112
Fax: 022-5953113
E-mail: sales@crystalonnet.com
Web site: www.diskeeper.com

3 MB of RAM. You can also schedule multiple partitions for defragmentation at one go.

The interface is plain and uncluttered. The help and documentation is detailed and explains the process for installation, and provides a glossary of more than a hundred terms used with disk fragmentation.

This application is meant for users who simultaneously work on multiple applications. Home users may not find this application worth their money since a software suite would take care of their defragmentation needs and much more for a similar price.

SPECIFICATIONS

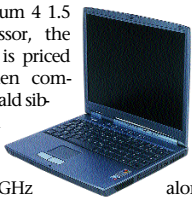
31.1 MB install size; supports Windows 98/Me/2000/NT/XP
System Requirements: Any Pentium processor based PC running Windows 9x and above with 32 MB RAM

Executive DisKeeper v7.0	
Performance	➤ ➤ ➤ ➤ ➤
Ease of use	➤ ➤ ➤ ➤ ➤
Value for money	➤ ➤ ➤ ➤ ➤
Features	➤ ➤ ➤ ➤ ➤
OVERALL	➤ ➤ ➤ ➤ ➤

ACi Impression notebook

Beauty in the beast

Using a Pentium 4 1.5 GHz processor, the ACi Impression is priced quite steep when compared to its Emerald sibling (reviewed in September 2002), which sports a P4 2.0 GHz processor and is almost Rs 20,000 cheaper. The laptop comes in an attractive leather case and the build quality is quite sturdy. The 14.1-inch TFT screen is powered by the nVidia GeForce 4 420 GO. This graphics card supported an astoundingly high resolution



of 2048x1768 but the screen panning makes it slightly cumbersome to use. It has a Hitachi 2.5-inch 20 GB hard disk drive, a Toshiba DVD-ROM drive along with 256 MB DDR memory, making it one of the most powerful laptops available. Its most individualistic features were blue LEDs instead of the usual orange and yellow, and an MMC slot along with a FireWire port and three USB ports.

However, there were a few

things amiss—the Windows key was placed inconveniently at the top right hand corner and the lock had to be jostled with to be opened, increasing its chances of wear and tear.

In the tests, BatteryMark 4.01 ran for 105 minutes (approximately 3 hours in real life). It scored 53 in Content Creation 2001, as compared to the average score of 45 by most laptops; Business

Price: Rs 1,04,999
Contact: Allied Computer International (Asia) Pvt Ltd
Phone: 022-6366800
E-mail: sales@aci-asia.com
Web site: www.aci-asia.com

Mercury Pocket DV Camera (4 in 1)

Smallest camera with a tripod

Ever wanted to have a device that could record voice, click still images, record video and act as a PC camera? Mercury Pocket DV Camera (4 in 1) is one device that gives you all these options. It has a USB interface and can record video up to a size of 640x480 at as high as 30 fps. The camera has a small LCD display that is quite helpful in understanding the various modes and using the camera optimally. It comes with a small tripod and another big plus is the applications bundled with the camera—there are two CDs filled with utilities such as Ulead Photo Express 4.0SE, Ulead Photo Explorer, Ulead Cool 360 and Ulead Video Studio. The bundled software offer quite a lot of features that complement the camera—you can easily control brightness, hue, saturation, contrast, etc, using the software.

Price: Rs 4,000
Contact: Visualan Technologies
Phone: 022-8202688
Fax: 022-8368514
E-mail: sales@visualanindia.com
Web site: www.kobian.com

Winstone 2001 failed due to compatibility issues.

The notebook comes in a metallic blue and grey combination with a neatly designed front panel—a delicate combination of beauty and speed.

SPECIFICATIONS

Pentium 4 1.5 GHz processor, 256 MB DDR RAM, 20 GB hard disk, 8x DVD-ROM drive, 14.1-inch LCD TFT Screen, GeForce 4 420 GO graphics processor

ACi Impression	
Performance	➤ ➤ ➤ ➤ ➤
Build quality	➤ ➤ ➤ ➤ ➤
Value for money	➤ ➤ ➤ ➤ ➤
Features	➤ ➤ ➤ ➤ ➤
OVERALL	➤ ➤ ➤ ➤ ➤



When not attached to the PC, its 16 MB on board SDRAM is sufficient to store around 3 minutes of video or around 200 images. However, there is no flash or aperture focus, so you might not be able to get the best pictures at night or even on a cloudy day. Another shortcoming is that the picture settings (brightness, hue, etc) can't be saved—you need to set it afresh every time.

Overall, this is a nice little device if you are interested in sharing videos and still images on the Web.

SPECIFICATIONS

128 MB onboard SDRAM memory; still camera, PC camera video mode, AV recording mode and voice recording mode; captures at a resolution of 640x480; package includes USB cables, installation manual, tripod stand and two AA batteries

Mercury Pocket DV	
Performance	➤ ➤ ➤ ➤ ➤
Build quality	➤ ➤ ➤ ➤ ➤
Value for money	➤ ➤ ➤ ➤ ➤
Features	➤ ➤ ➤ ➤ ➤
OVERALL	➤ ➤ ➤ ➤ ➤